

People Leaders

Performance toolkit



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What's in this toolkit?

In this toolkit you will find information on your own performance as a people leader, as well as everything you need to know to manage your team's performance.

It will answer questions such as:

- How do I set goals for my team?
- How do I write a comprehensive Performance Review?
- How do I have a performance conversation or deliver feedback that may be difficult?

Use this toolkit to help maximize your team's performance and strengthen your leadership.

Need something else?

Check out these other helpful resources:

- [Performance Improvement Toolkit](#)
- [Performance Toolkit for Mgmt Employees](#)
- [Development Toolkit for Mgmt Employees](#)
- [Performance Toolkit for People Leaders of Associates](#)
- [My Performance Page](#)
- [My Team's Performance in V Team Central](#)
- [Performance Review Job Aid for V Team Central](#)

What is performance management?

At Verizon, we view performance management as all of the **practices and processes** that **recognize, reward, and reinforce** the **behaviors, impacts, and outcomes** that drive **culture, innovation, and growth**.

It is a **partnership and shared responsibility** for V Teamers and their managers to set goals, align priorities, engage in continuous feedback, and steer development.

Performance management should be **forward-focused, inspiring, and motivating**; designed to encourage employees to go above and beyond.



What goes into performance management?



For you

Model the V Team Principles Goal

Our V Team Principles offer insight into the behaviors expected of all leaders and give you the blueprint to be a leader at what you do and how you work every day.

Why do we have a Model the V Team Principles Goal?

- It aligns Verizon leaders to one set of leadership behaviors - the V Team Principles.
- It defines “what good looks like” from a leader at Verizon.
- It helps every V Teamer take ownership of their role and continue to grow, lead and succeed.



V
Strategic
Leadership



Be Customer Centric

We obsess over our customers. Our focus begins and ends with enabling better internal and external customer experiences.



Deliver Innovation

What got us here, won't get us there, so we don't settle. Instead, we roll up our sleeves, embrace and champion change to spark innovation.



We
Inclusive
Leadership



Embrace Inclusion

We create inclusive environments because our strength as a company is based on the strength of the V Team. We seek diverse perspectives, listen and create safe, open environments where every individual can be and feel welcomed, respected, supported, and valued to fully participate.



Activate Teamwork

We bring others along and we win as a team. To do this we act unselfishly, and communicate transparently and authentically. We work to remove obstacles to team success and prioritize recognizing and rewarding team performance.



Me
Authentic
Leadership



Model Integrity

We hold ourselves accountable and always act with integrity. We don't take shortcuts or adopt a "win at all costs" mentality. We advocate for, adopt and demonstrate our Culture OS values of Trust, Care and Excellence.



Champion Growth

We support and root for one another as we learn and develop. We actively give, receive, and implement constructive feedback. We work to continuously grow and stretch beyond our current capabilities.

Model the V Team Principle goal



How it works:

The Model the V Team Principles goal is automatically added to every People Leader's Performance Goals at the beginning of the year. If you are promoted or hired as a People Leader during the year, your Model the V Team Principles Goal will be automatically added shortly after you move into your new role.

When crafting your accomplishments for the Model the V Team Principles goal, consider:

What you achieved and how you achieved it.

How did you meaningfully bring the V Team Principles to life every day?

On the next two pages, you will find sample accomplishments matched to a V Team Principle.

V Team Principles Sample Accomplishments

Use these samples to help craft your accomplishments before mid-year or year-end!

Be Customer Centric

Instilled regular recognition systems, processes and awareness within the team whenever a team member put the "Customer First." Actions taken to recognize this behavior included: [insert actions]. Increased customer first behaviors were measured by: [outcome here].

Embrace Inclusion

Created an inclusive environment on my team by changing our meeting structure to save time for each team member to share their ideas at the end of the meeting. Results measured by [outcome here].

Model Integrity

Incorporated integrity into performance goals for the team, ensuring that goals are met in a way that aligns with our values. Results measured by [360, Pulse+, informal surveys].

Deliver Innovation

Brought innovation forward by implementing a process to capture ideas from all levels within my organization on a regular basis. Results or changes in behavior were measured by [business outcomes]

Activate Teamwork

Used developmental assignments and intentionally staffed projects [insert projects here] to include cross-functional resources and ensured inclusive collaboration by taking the following actions: [actions here].

Champion Growth

Developed individuals by delegating specific projects [insert projects] that stretched my team's development and put these management routines in place to empower them for completion. Results measured by increase in metrics via [360, ready in 1-3 year bench, Pulse+].

For your team

Performance throughout the year

Goal Setting: Set and discuss SMART performance goals with your employee at the beginning of the year.

Mid-Year Review: Assess and discuss performance from the first half of the year and update performance goals and development actions for the second half.

Year-End Review: Review your employee's performance against their goals and assign a performance rating.

Continuous Conversations: Throughout the year, have ongoing conversations about performance and development, and how your employee is making progress towards their goals. You can use the 2+2 model. Learn more about 2+2s [here](#)!



Unconscious bias



How to mitigate bias in Performance Reviews



Before we get started on Performance Reviews, it's important to be aware of our biases. Taking a P.A.U.S.E can help you proactively check assumptions and biases so they don't influence your action during performance reviews.

Pause:

Pay attention to what's actually happening, beneath any judgements you have about the employee.

Acknowledge:

Acknowledge your own reactions, interpretations and judgement.

Understand:

Explore if there are other possible reactions, interpretations and judgments outside the ones you have that may be possible.

Search:

Search for the most empowering, productive way to be objective when reviewing performance.

Execute:

Execute your action plan to ensure a fair review for each team member. This should include focusing only on job-related information and reviewing each team member based on the same criteria.

Unconscious Biases & Performance Reviews

1 Affinity Bias

AKA, just like me bias, is the tendency to identify with those with whom we share certain characteristics, attitudes, or interests, and evaluate them more favorably simply because they are similar to us. For example: favoring a team member that attended the same school as you.

2 Availability Bias

Commonly known as recency bias causes us to reference and talk only about projects and outcomes that are most recent, and therefore more easily accessible in our memory. For example: Your team member earned recognition on a recent, high profile project. While it is okay to reference recent accomplishments, be sure to evaluate the full performance period.

3 Confirmation Bias

Occurs when we only look for information that confirms our beliefs and ignore what contradicts our beliefs. For example: Giving a team member a high rating because they have performed well in the past, even though they didn't meet their current performance goals.

4 Halo and Horn Bias

The Halo bias occurs when we unconsciously allow a single positive trait or characteristic to prevent us from objectively evaluating someone's performance. For example: Someone dressed in a suit might be seen as more competent than someone dressed in a t-shirt.

The opposite of Halo, is the Horn bias, which occurs when we allow a single negative trait or characteristic to prevent us from objectively evaluating someone's performance. For example: Someone in a suit could be viewed as too business-like for the current culture, and be viewed as less approachable than someone in a t-shirt.

Goal setting



Creating Performance Goals



When collaborating with your employees on creating goals keep the following in mind:

Make sure goals are SMART

Specific: What exactly is expected to get done?
Measurable: How will you know the goal has been achieved?
Achievable: Can this goal realistically be accomplished?
Relevant: Does this goal align with individual, team and organizational priorities?
Time bound: When is the goal expected to be achieved?

Align with the big picture

Talk with your employee about how their goals contribute to broader team or organizational goals.

When your employee knows how they influence the outcomes of the team and the company, they are more likely to feel connected to our overall mission of powering and empowering how people live, work and play.

Think about the final outcome

Ensure there are tangible success measures or metrics so it's clear when the goal has been achieved. What do success measures look like?
Shonda completed Project Y on or under budget.
Carlos delivered Project X on time for a Q2 launch.
Jacque raised all implementation risks before they became critical.
Mark increased our website traffic by 40% more than the target.

What are success metrics?

Success metrics are measurable data used to determine the success of the goal or objective.

For some goals with quantitative metrics this is straight forward, for example cable placed per hour, or % call resolution. However for qualitative goals generating success metrics can be tricky. Think about how exactly you'll know if this goal was achieved? What will be different? What has improved? How do you know? Think about success metrics for the following goals.

Goal	Potential success metrics
Implement a knowledge sharing system for the team by Q2.	Pulse results on questions Q1 and Q2, survey of team and stakeholders.
Contribute to the culture of the team by planning monthly events.	Pulse results on question Q0, frequency of team collaboration, quantity of ideas and process improvements generated.
Improve the stakeholder relationship with European counterparts over the first half of the year.	% of on track activities within the project, stakeholder feedback survey results (satisfaction, NPS, general feedback), decreased time to market on products.

Creating performance goals



Goal setting checklist

- I have identified the best way for this employee to contribute to the team based on their individual strengths and interests.
- I have ensured that this is a SMART goal.
- I have included what results are expected, by when, and how results will be measured.
- I have anticipated what questions my employee may ask about this goal.
- I have anticipated what roadblocks might exist for this goal and have planned to provide the support needed to reach it.
- I have discussed with my employee how their goals align with team goals and business priorities.

Example goals

- Implement a new method of communication for the team by Q2 resulting in decreased emails and increased engagement on the corresponding Pulse question.
- Address all customer escalations within 24 hours with a 98% customer satisfaction rating.
- Implement system upgrade by the end of the 2nd quarter and within budget.
- Achieve billing error reduction of at least 25-30% by year-end.
- Deploy 28 market MVP packets to ensure infrastructure readiness by Q4.

Performance reviews



The purpose



The checklist



Examples



Writing performance reviews



Performance reviews give you the opportunity to recognize employees for their contributions, reinforce that their work matters and coach them to enable higher levels of performance.

To be most effective, make sure the written review:

- Has no surprises! The review should reflect the feedback and coaching you have given your employee throughout the year.
- Focuses on the future. Your review should not only reflect on past performance, but motivate and inspire employees to higher levels of performance.
- Aligns with the conversation. The review should be easy to translate into an honest and constructive discussion with your employee.

For more details, see the [Performance Summary Checklist](#) on the next page.

Writing performance reviews

Remember, when writing reviews, be relevant, be specific and include detailed examples.

Performance Summary Checklist:

- ☐ I have summarized the employee's results compared to their goals.
- ☐ I have described accomplishments and what was done well.
- ☐ I have identified what can be done better, and how it can be improved.
- ☐ I have described what the employee should focus on moving forward.
- ☐ I included "how" the employee achieved their goals:
 - Described behaviors that demonstrated our values as part of Culture OS. For example, include reference to Employee Resource Group (ERG) accomplishments.
 - Described how they brought the V Team Principles to life.
- ☐ For my team members who are People Leaders, I have described how they inspired their teams to deliver results.

Sample Performance Summaries



High Performer : People Leader

High Performer : Individual Contributor

Low Performer : People Leader

Low Performer : Individual Contributor

Sample Performance Summaries: High Performer



Sue had an excellent year with an overall scorecard attainment of 102%. She met all goals and exceeded targets in first call resolution at 101% and net revenue at 103%, against 100% targets. Sue focused on limiting repeats which improved by 15% and held her team accountable to create the best customer experience possible. She utilized local team incentives and effectively coached her team to achieve sales goals by increasing their skills in overcoming objections and selling on value. She consistently drove results and received three customer commendations.

Sue demonstrates our values as part of Culture OS by taking personal accountability for the results her team achieves and has implemented system improvements that positively impacted the customer experience. Sue is a strong leader who demonstrates the V Team Principles. She excels in building relationships and engaged her team to work successfully together to deliver improved results. She's made good progress in developing new team members and she motivates her employees by giving monthly feedback, coaching and recognition. Looking ahead, Sue has an opportunity to build on her momentum in driving growth and superior service by challenging her team to question the status quo and strengthening cross-functional team relationships.

Sample Performance Summaries: High Performer



Jim is a strong performer and has done an excellent job delivering on his goals. He is knowledgeable on our products and services and has a strong desire to keep his customers satisfied. This is evident in his achievement of 102% for the customer experience goal (vs 100% target) and received two customer commendations. He does an outstanding job contacting his customers as well as soliciting their feedback. Jim is very productive and met the objective at 95% due to his attention to detail and efficiency. Jim is committed to understanding customer needs and ensuring customer expectations are exceeded.

He brings a host of positive attributes to his work such as a sense of urgency, and a willingness to do whatever is asked of him including working overtime when needed. He demonstrated personal accountability in serving our customers during a recent outage when there was no direct solution but Jim came up with a temporary alternative and service was back in 24 hours. Going forward, Jim should continue his focus on providing excellent customer experiences, setting the example for the team. I am also looking for Jim to share his knowledge with others on the team through coaching and mentoring and would like him to take the initiative to apply his knowledge by suggesting process improvements.

Sample Performance Summaries: Low Performer



Tom struggled to meet performance expectations and fell short on achieving key goals. His overall scorecard attainment was 82% (vs. target of 100%) due to his productivity and rework results that were far below target. Tom needs to do a better job monitoring his team on a daily basis, identifying problem areas and coaching his team to improve performance. He needs to conduct more job inspections and do ride-alongs to ensure his employees are working smartly, confirming that all services are working properly before leaving the location and educating the customer on the services provided. Tom met the safety goals and has done a good job ensuring that safety is a priority and an integral part of the work process. He is very knowledgeable and willing to take on new challenges. Tom demonstrates our values as part of Culture OS by acting with integrity and urgency demonstrated by his timely responses/personal involvement on customer escalations.

As a leader, Tom needs to better demonstrate consistent coaching and follow-up with his team. He needs to hold his employees accountable and provide necessary training. I expect Tom to address low performers on his team and use the performance improvement process to turn performance around. Going forward, Tom must focus on improving productivity and quality to achieve better results for our customers. To drive improved overall team performance, it is critical for Tom to provide strong leadership to help his team work better together along with the right coaching at the right time for each employee.

Sample Performance Summaries: Low Performer



Josie performed below expectations and did not meet her customer experience and revenue goals. Josie did not consistently follow call flow scripts nor ask enough probing questions which could help with efficiency of her calls. This resulted in Josie receiving an observation score of 61% compared to the 80% target. Josie's revenue results were 65% of target and her close rates were low. To achieve 100% attainment, Josie must focus on close rates and upgrades to drive revenue to target. Josie will enroll in additional product refresher training to increase her knowledge of the products and promotions. Josie partners well with others and demonstrates teamwork by her reliability and willingness to help her teammates when needed. She's accountable for her work and has been very receptive to coaching to improve her customer focus. She has shown improvement in asking open ended questions to get customer information and to help find solutions.

Josie needs to continue to work on active listening and empathizing to build better rapport. She must improve her revenue results by better utilizing customer information to make recommendations. In our coaching sessions, I have worked with Josie to confirm understanding of the customer's needs, improve offering solutions to the customer and anticipate future needs to ensure the customer receives complete resolution. Improving the closing/recap process will help increase the customer experience. I expect Josie to continue to focus on making improvements in these areas.

Performance ratings



Top Performing

Exceeding

Achieving

Approaching

Needs Improvement

New Year-End 2024! 5-point Rating Scale



Top Performing	Far exceeds all goals, requirements and expectations; Strongest contributions and impact in the organization
Exceeding	Exceeds all or most goals, requirements and expectations
Achieving	Meets all goals, requirements and expectations and periodically exceeds some
Approaching	Meets some goals, requirements and expectations, but has opportunity to improve on one or more goals
Needs Improvement	Not meeting most goals, requirements and expectations; Significant improvement is needed

New/Not Rated: Achievement relative to performance goals cannot be evaluated due to short tenure. Applicable in the following situations:

- New to Company (less than 6 months)- New/Not Rated can be assigned for employees hired/rehired July 1 - Sep 30, and must be assigned for new employees hired/rehired on or after Oct 1
- Performing duties less than 3 months of the year due to an authorized absence or leave (except that employees performing duties less than 3 months of the year due to military leave should be rated as Achieving)

Note: “New/Not Rated” may not be used for a transferred or promoted employee; a consolidated rating for the year should be assigned.

Performance conversations



Before the conversation



During the conversation



After the conversation



Ongoing conversation

verizon



Before the conversation



It's important to prepare!

The more prepared you are, the more likely it is that you will have an engaging dialogue with your employee that inspires them to do their best.

Before the conversation remember to:

Schedule sufficient time in a private setting. Decide whether you will be meeting virtually or face to face. If you are in person, be sure you have secured a quiet place where you won't be interrupted. See this page for tips on virtual meetings.

Complete your review in the system and be sure to submit the Manager Acknowledgement. This will allow your employee to see the review as well.

When you are ready to **share the written performance review with your employee**, acknowledge the document in the system which will release it to the employee for their review. If possible, acknowledge ahead of the meeting to give your employee a chance to prepare for the review discussion.

Prepare. Ask yourself the questions on the following page and think about any questions or concerns the employee may have. How will you respond?

Before the conversation



Ask yourself these questions to prepare:

What did the employee accomplish and how did they accomplish it?

How do the employee's accomplishments support overall team and organizational goals?

What did the employee do well?

Where are there opportunities to improve, develop and grow?

How did the employee model our values as part of Culture OS and demonstrate the V Team Principles?

What should the employee start, stop, and continue doing?

What are specific examples you can give of these behaviors?

What questions can you ask to encourage a conversation?

How might the employee react to this information? For difficult situations, anticipate questions and prepare answers.

During the conversation



Follow the tips below and the conversation guide on the next page to have a productive and engaging discussion.

Do:

- Allow employee opportunity to provide input
- Be able to support your review (and rating) with specific examples and observations
- State results in factual or quantifiable manner
- Provide honest praise for accomplishments
- Proofread your review before delivering it to the employee
- Be aware of biases. Notice and challenge your automatic and reflexive thinking
- Express appreciation for your employee

Don't:

- Provide general comments on performance with no observations or examples of the behavior
- Compare your employee's performance to their peers
- Make assumptions about performance
- Base the review on memory alone without facts and metrics to back it up
- Use extreme words, such as “never” and “always” or the word “weakness”
- Express subjective or judgemental opinions

Do

Begin with mentioning your employee’s strengths and what was done well.

Identify opportunities to improve and develop.

Share how the employee modeled our values and how people leaders modeled the V Team Principles.

Make connections to the big picture and reinforce how the employee’s work impacts our customers.

Ask open-ended questions.

Listen to your employee’s perspective - adopt an open mind.

Align on expectations, next steps and action items.

End on a positive note and ask what support is needed.



Say

This year you really delivered on [insert outcome or behavior].

One thing I think could be improved is [insert topic]. For example in [insert situation] you did [insert behavior] something that may have worked better is [insert behavior]

I noticed that you often ask other team members for their ideas during meetings. That really represents the V Team Principles Activate Teamwork and Embrace Inclusion. Thank you for bringing that strength to the team!

When you did [insert behavior] you allowed Sabrina’s team to move forward with their work. Your contribution was critical to delivering the project on time!

How do you think you contributed to the team’s goals this year?

What do you think? Do you agree? How do you see it?

Do you have any questions about next steps?

Overall you provided tremendous value to our team this year! As we wrap up, is there anything I can do to support you moving forward?



Virtual conversations



WorkForward is here! As we continue to get used to our new ways of working, we know some performance conversations will be virtual. We also know the remote work environment can be full of disruptions not present in the office. Take a look at these tips to have effective conversations in a hybrid world.

Turn your camera on and ask your employees to do the same. It's more personal, engaging and allows you to see non-verbal cues.

Start by making sure employees are in a quiet, private space, if possible, and reassure employees you are speaking from a private location as well. If a disruption does occur, schedule additional time to continue the conversation.

Pay close attention to expressions and body language – both yours and your employee. Be sure to project openness in your posture.

Use your awareness of non-verbal cues to ask more specific questions and make sure things aren't lost in translation.

Encourage back and forth communication and listen carefully. Having some silence to allow time for responses or gathering thoughts is good.

Restate important messages and any next steps to ensure understanding in light of possible distractions when working from home.

After the conversation

After you've met with your employee to discuss their performance, make sure to follow up with these action items!

- 1** Partner with your employee to update their Performance Goals and Development Actions. Some may need more guidance than others.
- 2** Don't wait to share feedback! Schedule 2+2 conversations to discuss progress against goals and provide day-to-day feedback in your 1:1s.
- 3** Celebrate wins and inspire continued success with recognition and in the moment feedback.

Have a 2+2

These are moments that matter!

2+2 Template

Start 2+2

2+2 Conversations are opportunities to step back from your day-to-day work and have a conversation about progress towards performance and development goals.

You will share:

1. **two** comments on progress towards performance or development goals and
2. **two** items your employee should do more or less of to increase performance or advance development moving forward.

Download a [template](#) to help you prep or start your 2+2 now!

- Be intentional about creating these moments.
- Set recurring meetings for these conversations and do your best not to move the time.
- Make sure your 2+2s do not turn into 1:1 conversations. Try to avoid talking about day-to-day responsibilities and focus more on the big picture.
- No need to wait for a 2+2! Give timely, actionable and constructive feedback as close to “in the moment” as possible and offer support and guidance to help remove obstacles in between your 2+2 Conversations.

